CONNECT DAILY

Friday 16 October 2026
themapsproject.com

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- CST's Annual Conference wrapped up today in Birmingham, with trust leaders focused on how the Schools White Paper and SEND reforms land in practice for mainstream inclusion.

  → **For your school:** *Worth checking CST's post-event output if your trust was represented.*

- Today (16 Oct) employers can formally start consulting staff on pay policies for the 3.5% 2026-27 teacher pay award - the Pay Order itself still has to clear Parliament.
- A quieter day otherwise: no major new England-wide SEND or inclusion announcements since yesterday's Ofsted leadership story, which remains unresolved.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

16 Oct 2026 — Employers in England can begin consulting staff on updated pay policies for the 2026-27 teacher pay award.

19 Oct 2026 — Sheffield City Council finance and performance committee votes on £602k funding for the Firth Park Academy SEND-places expansion.

26-30 Oct 2026 — Sheffield schools' autumn half term.

CST ANNUAL CONFERENCE: TRUSTS ON SEND REFORM

- **Trust leaders convene on 'Connecting' theme.** The Confederation of School Trusts' Annual Conference ran 15-16 October at Birmingham's ICC, with sessions on how sector and civic leaders respond to the Schools White Paper and SEND reforms - including a breakout on 'Inclusive by design: creating environments where all learners thrive'. (CST)

PAY & FUNDING

- **Pay policy consultations open today.** From 16 October, employers can consult staff on pay policies reflecting the accepted 3.5% uplift for 2026-27 (5% at the bottom of the unqualified range), backdated to 1 September. The Pay Order itself still needs to clear its parliamentary praying period before arrears follow. (NASUWT)

JARGON-BUSTER - OAIP

Cropping up at this week's CST conference on SEND reform:

Ordinarily Available Inclusive Practice - the support mainstream schools should provide without needing an EHCP, now being folded into local 'ordinarily available provision' guidance as part of the wider SEND reforms.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.